Chicopee Hills Parent Council – Feb 17, 2026

Attendees:
In person: Kathleen Carr, Colleen Bishop, Bushra Shahid, Erica Quayle, Kat Oue
Online: Louise Caswell
Regrets - Jenni Guy

Hot Topics – Use of Generative AI in the WRDSB

- AI launching soon for students – still training teachers at this time
- Reactive, generative and predictive AI
- Reactive – Alexa, google assistant, Siri
- Generative – Gemini, Copilot, Canva
- Predictive – Netflix, google maps, Grammarly, amazon
- Teach the students how to teach them
- What AI Does well – synthesize information, generate examples, generate fast responses, new ideas, language translation, helps with conceptual understanding
- What AI doesn't do well – empathy and emotional intelligence, recognising bias, contextual understanding, verifying facts, authentic voice, ethical thinking,
- Risk migration – WRDSB taken a measured and systemic approach to rolling out SI; no personal info, existing oversight proves, secure environment, changes to be responsible use of procedure, comprehensive review
- Ore commitments – prioritize humane and ethical use, empower learning and innovation, endure fair and inclusive practice, promote transparency and accountability
- Timelines
    - Phase 1 – research and planning
    - Phase 2 – staff training, guidelines for staff, expectations for students, students start in April 2026
    - Phase 3 – development of materials to support educators by educators
- Be AI SMART – stop – Stop -don't give personal information, Make it yours, Acknowledge AI use, Review expectations, Think critically

Concerns raised by Parent council

- What are the safeguards in place to help protect the kids and the proper use of the tools?
- What are the consequences for misuse of the tools?
- Will there be a consent form for parents to fill out before allowing their children to use AI?

- Can we make information about AI and the launch within the school available to parents before it gets launched to the students? A possible Town Hall?

Financial Update

a) School council funds - $15, 405 (minus new purchase below)
b) WEFI = $9, 726.28
    a. $8,167.80 (outdoor learning)
    b. $1,558.48 (general)
c) Factory shoes = $1270.00
d) Mabels labels = unknown
e) Poinsettias = $542
f) Holiday market = unknown

New purchases

- Headphones $294.25
- Books $1124.17

Total - $15, 405 less above.

Current staff requests for purchases – Bushra

- Book club requests – and updates Kat

Request – could council provide an amount for the intermediate classes to purchase books for their class library

- How much
- What vendors to use
- About 6 classes per grade, total 12 classes
- Suggested amount $1000-2000 per floor
- To cover books that are popular
- To vote on this next meeting

Concern – teacher and parent buy in

- Staff supporting school / parent council events
- Can we update the staff list online?

Fundraising and Event Updates

a) Science Fair (Kat)
b) Book Fair (Caitlin)
    a. Main concern – need coverage (2 parents) during the day for the week and one evening to cover the book fair
    b. Week of April 13th

    c. Alternative – run two evenings per week to have students come in with their parents instead of a full week of viewing then purchasing

c) Staff Appreciation Day (Ariana) – next meeting

d) Canopies – ordered and received; quote for banners received and will be sent out to vote via email.

e) School sign – can we do a survey to go out to parents for the sign, and make it a hook for the next meeting

f) Air bands & Art show
   - need a schedule for practice and additional supervision otherwise show cannot move forward

g) End of year BBQ- next meeting

Upcoming Changes

- Teacher requests – to request funds from council, must attend a meeting to present request; this to help facilitate more staff involvement in parent council
- For email to parents about Parent council – give the summary of what topics are being addresses

Next Meeting – April 21 (no March meeting)

- Will there be a consent form for students to use AI
- Book binding machine
- Staff appreciation day
- Book request for intermediate classes – book clubs
- Ask for staff contact info to be updated online
- Possibly send an update to parents through school day after meetings (to help with clarity)
- Outdoor learning funds – what to do with this? What is the definition of outdoor learning?
- End of year BBQ

To add to the school Calendar

- Add art show – April 30th
- All Holidays
- Add library / gym / facility closures

Next year

- Put all dates of parent council events in the school calendar
- Move air bands to December to be able to practice outside